User Manual

Research & Technology Transfer Management System

Version 1.0 | June 2026

Research & Technology Transfer Platform

RTT Platform — User Manual

Research & Technology Transfer Management System Version 1.0 | June 2026

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1. Introduction

Welcome to the **RTT Platform** — the Research and Technology Transfer Management System. This platform supports the complete lifecycle of research proposals, from initial submission through peer review, funding, monitoring, and final completion. It also manages conferences, external grants, budget requests, and research output publications.

This manual is written for end users of all roles. Whether you are a researcher submitting a proposal, an officer reviewing submissions, a finance officer processing budgets, or an administrator managing the system, this guide covers every feature available to you.

How to Use This Manual

- Use the **Table of Contents** to jump directly to the section you need.
- Sections marked **(Admin)** require administrative or officer-level access.
- Sections marked **(Feature-gated)** may not be visible if the feature has been disabled by your system administrator.
- **[Screenshot: Feature Name]** placeholders indicate where screenshots would appear in the printed or PDF version of this manual.

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2. System Overview

The RTT Platform is organized into the following major modules:

Module	Purpose
Proposals	Submit, track, and manage research proposals through a multi-stage review workflow
Review & Evaluation	Multi-stage peer review: validation, blind review, open defence, central evaluation
Finance	Budget allocations, budget requests, disbursements, and settlements
Monitoring	Midterm evaluations, completion workshops, research outputs
Reports	Analytics, performance metrics, and exportable reports
External Funds	Manage applications for external grants and donor funding
Conferences	Conference management and abstract submission
Repository	Public listing of completed research outputs
Complaints	File and resolve complaints about the review process
Administration	User management, roles, colleges, departments, settings

Proposal Lifecycle

Every proposal follows a defined workflow:

```
Draft → Submitted → Validated → Under Blind Review → Blind Review Passed
     → Under Open Defence → Accepted → Funded → Midterm Evaluation
     → Completed → (Archived)

At any stage: → Rejected
```

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3. User Roles and Permissions

The system uses role-based access control. Each user is assigned one or more roles that determine what they can see and do.

Role Summary

Role	Description
Super Admin	Full access to all features, settings, roles, permissions, and system configuration
Admin	Manages settings, public site, login notices, and feedback; cannot change roles or permissions
Central Officer	Oversees all proposals across categories; performs central evaluation; monitors the system
Research Officer	Validates and reviews proposals in the Research category only
Community Officer	Validates and reviews proposals in the Community Engagement category only
Technology Officer	Validates and reviews proposals in the Technology Transfer category only
College Officer	Manages proposals, users, and departments within a specific college
Finance Officer	Manages all budget-related processes: allocations, requests, disbursements, settlements
Staff / Researcher	Submits and tracks own proposals; receives notifications; participates as reviewer when assigned
Guest	Read-only access to public pages: proposals, calls, repository, conferences

> **Note:** Your system administrator may create custom roles with specific permission combinations.

Scope Restrictions

Some roles are **scoped**, meaning their access is automatically filtered:

- **Category-scoped officers** (Research, Community, Technology) only see proposals in their assigned category.
- **College-scoped officers** (College Officer) only see data belonging to their assigned college.

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4. Getting Started

4.1 Accessing the System

Open your web browser and navigate to the RTT Platform URL provided by your institution. The system works best on modern browsers: Chrome, Firefox, Edge, or Safari (latest versions).

[Screenshot: Login Page]

4.2 Logging In

The system supports three login methods depending on what your administrator has enabled:

Email and Password Login

1. On the login page, enter your **Email Address** and **Password**.
2. Click **Sign In**.
3. If Two-Factor Authentication is enabled on your account, you will be prompted to enter a verification code (see Section 4.3).

Microsoft / Azure AD (SSO)

1. On the login page, click **Sign in with Microsoft**.
2. You will be redirected to the Microsoft login page.
3. Enter your institutional Microsoft credentials.
4. On first login, you may be asked to authorize the RTT Platform application.
5. You will be redirected back to the RTT Platform dashboard.

Telegram Login

1. On the login page, click **Sign in with Telegram**.
2. Follow the Telegram bot prompts to link your account.
3. Once authorized, you will be logged in.

Common Login Errors:

Error	Solution
"Invalid credentials"	Check your email and password; use "Forgot Password" if needed
"Account is inactive"	Contact your administrator to reactivate your account
"Email not verified"	Check your inbox for a verification email and click the link
"Too many login attempts"	Wait a few minutes before trying again (rate limit: 30 attempts per minute)

4.3 Two-Factor Authentication

If 2FA is enabled on your account:

1. After entering your credentials, you will see a **2FA Verification** screen.
2. A 6-digit code will be sent to your registered email address.
3. Enter the code in the verification field.
4. Click **Verify**.
5. If you did not receive the code, click **Resend Code** (available after a short delay).

> **Note:** 2FA codes expire after a few minutes. If the code expires, request a new one.

[Screenshot: Two-Factor Authentication Screen]

4.4 Resetting Your Password

1. On the login page, click **Forgot Password?**
2. Enter your registered email address and click **Send Reset Link**.
3. Check your email inbox for a password reset message.
4. Click the link in the email. The link is valid for a limited time.
5. Enter and confirm your new password.
6. Click **Reset Password**.
7. You will be redirected to the login page. Log in with your new password.

4.5 Your Profile

To view or edit your profile:

1. Click your **avatar or name** in the top-right corner of any page.
2. Select **Profile** from the dropdown menu.

Profile fields you can update:

- Full Name
- Phone Number
- Gender
- Title / Position
- Avatar (profile photo)
- Notification preferences (email alerts, Telegram)

Fields managed by administrators:

- Email address
- College and Department affiliation
- Employee ID
- Role assignments
- Account status

[Screenshot: User Profile Page]

4.6 Session Timeout

For security, your session will automatically expire after a period of inactivity (configured by your administrator, typically 30–60 minutes).

- A **warning dialog** will appear a few minutes before your session expires.
- Click **Stay Logged In** to continue your session.
- If you do not respond, you will be automatically logged out.
- Any unsaved work (such as an in-progress proposal draft) may be preserved in draft state but unsaved form data may be lost.

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5. Dashboard

The Dashboard is your home page after logging in. It displays a real-time summary of items that require your attention.

[Screenshot: Main Dashboard]

Dashboard Widgets

The widgets shown on your dashboard depend on your role. Common widgets include:

Widget	Description	Visible To
Active Proposal Calls	Number of currently open proposal calls	All
My Proposals (Draft)	Your proposals still in draft state	Staff / Researchers
Validation Queue	Proposals waiting to be validated	Officers
Blind Review Queue	Proposals in blind review stage	Officers
Open Defence Queue	Proposals scheduled for open defence	Officers
Central Evaluation Queue	Proposals awaiting central decision	Central Officer
Assigned Reviews	Peer reviews assigned to you	Any reviewer
Awarded (Unfunded)	Accepted proposals not yet funded	Finance Officer
Midterm Evaluations Pending	Funded proposals due for midterm review	Officers
Completion Workshops Pending	Proposals due for completion assessment	Officers
Budget Requests Pending	Budget requests awaiting your action	Finance Officer / College Officer
Proposal Funding Queue	Proposals ready for funding decision	Finance Officer
Pending Disbursements	Approved budgets awaiting payment	Finance Officer
Pending Settlements	Disbursed funds awaiting settlement	Finance Officer
Open Complaints	Unresolved complaints	Officers
Similarity Flags	Proposals flagged for similarity	Officers
Unread Notifications	Your unread notification count	All

Dashboard Charts

Below the widgets, charts give a visual overview of the proposal pipeline:

- **Proposal Pipeline** — count of proposals at each status
- **Proposals by Category** — breakdown by Research / Community / Technology / Innovation
- **Proposals by College** — distribution across colleges

- **Proposal Trend** — submissions over time
- **Budget Utilization** — allocated vs. utilized budget by college
- **Reviewer Performance** — reviewer workload and completion metrics

> **Tip:** Click on any widget number to navigate directly to the relevant list.

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6. My Research Hub

Path: Main Menu → My Research Hub

The Research Hub provides a personal overview of all your research activities in one place.

[Screenshot: Research Hub]

What you can see here:

- Summary of all your submitted proposals and their current status
- Your assigned peer review tasks and deadlines
- Upcoming milestone dates (midterm evaluations, completion workshops)
- Recent activity and notifications related to your proposals
- Quick links to start a new application or track an existing one

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7. Proposal Management

7.1 Browsing Proposal Calls

Path: Proposals → Proposal Calls

Proposal calls are announcements inviting researchers to submit proposals. Only **active** calls are open for submissions.

[Screenshot: Proposal Calls List]

Call Information displayed:

- Call title and category (Research, Community, Technology, Innovation)
- Academic year
- Submission deadline with countdown timer
- Status badge (Active, Expired, Closed)
- Download link for guidelines document

Filtering calls:

- Filter by **Category**
- Filter by **Academic Year**
- Search by **title keyword**

To view full call details:

1. Click the call title or the **View** button.
2. The detail page shows: eligibility criteria, guidelines, deadline, and a button to start a new application.

> **Note:** The "New Application" button only appears if the call is currently active and you have not exceeded the maximum allowed proposals for that call.

7.2 Creating a New Proposal (Wizard)

Path: Proposals → New Application (or click "Apply Now" from a proposal call)

Who can access: Staff, Researchers, and any authenticated user with proposal creation permission.

The proposal is created through a **7-step wizard**. Your progress is saved at each step so you can return and continue later.

Step 1 — Basic Information

[Screenshot: Proposal Wizard Step 1]

Field	Required	Notes
Proposal Title	Yes	Descriptive title; max 255 characters
Abstract	Yes	200–500 words summarizing the proposal
Keywords	Yes	3–10 keywords separated by commas
Proposal Category	Yes	Research / Community Engagement / Technology Transfer / Innovation
Focus Area	Yes	Selected from the list for your chosen category
Research Type	Yes	Basic, Applied, Experimental, Clinical, Action, Review/Meta-analysis
Duration (months)	Yes	Expected project duration in months
Academic Year	Yes	The call's academic year (pre-filled if applying from a call)
Proposal Call	Yes	The specific call you are applying to

Validation: All fields are required. The abstract must meet the minimum word count.

To proceed: Click **Save & Next** to save Step 1 and move to Step 2.

Step 2 — Principal Investigator (PI) Information

[Screenshot: Proposal Wizard Step 2]

This step captures the details of the Principal Investigator — the person responsible for the proposal.

Field	Required	Notes
PI Name	Yes	Full legal name
PI Email	Yes	Institutional email
PI Phone	No	Contact phone number
College	Yes	PI's affiliated college
Department	Yes	PI's department within the college
Employee ID	No	Institutional employee ID
Qualification	No	Highest academic qualification
Specialization	No	Area of expertise

> **Note:** If you are the PI, this information may be pre-filled from your profile.

Step 3 — Research Team

[Screenshot: Proposal Wizard Step 3]

Add co-investigators who will participate in the research.

To add a team member:

1. Click **Add Co-Investigator**.
2. Search for the person by name or email (must be a registered system user).
3. Select their role on the team (Co-PI, Research Assistant, Collaborator, etc.).
4. Click **Add**.

Team member statuses:

- **Pending** — invitation sent, awaiting acceptance
- **Accepted** — member confirmed participation
- **Refused** — member declined; you can remove them or invite someone else

> **Important:** Co-investigators who have not accepted will still be listed on the proposal. Officers can see acceptance status.

Step 4 — Budget Plan

[Screenshot: Proposal Wizard Step 4]

Create a detailed budget for your proposal. Budget items are organized by category.

Budget Categories:

- Personnel
- Equipment
- Materials & Supplies
- Travel & Fieldwork
- Workshop & Training
- Software & Licenses
- Publication
- Overhead / Indirect Costs
- Other

To add a budget line item:

1. Select a **Budget Category** from the dropdown.
2. Enter a **Description** of the expense.
3. Enter the **Amount** (in local currency).
4. Add a **Justification** explaining why this expense is necessary.
5. Click **Add Item**.

Budget summary: The total budget is calculated automatically as you add items.

Validation:

- At least one budget item is required.
- Amounts must be positive numbers.
- Budget must not exceed any maximum set by the call.

Step 5 — Documents

[Screenshot: Proposal Wizard Step 5]

Upload supporting documents for your proposal.

Document types you may upload:

- Full Proposal Document (PDF)
- Budget Justification

- CVs of Team Members
- Ethical Clearance / IRB Approval
- Letters of Support
- Other Supporting Documents

To upload a document:

1. Click **Upload Document** or drag and drop a file.
2. Select the **Document Type** from the dropdown.
3. Enter an optional **Description**.
4. Click **Upload**.

File requirements:

- Accepted formats: PDF, DOC, DOCX, XLS, XLSX, JPG, PNG
- Maximum file size: as configured by your administrator (typically 10 MB per file)

> **Tip:** Upload the full proposal document as a PDF for best compatibility with the review system.

Step 6 — Preview

[Screenshot: Proposal Wizard Step 6]

Review all the information you have entered across all steps before submitting.

This page shows:

- Complete proposal details (title, abstract, keywords, category, focus area)
- PI information
- Team members and their acceptance status
- Full budget breakdown with totals
- Uploaded documents list

If you need to make changes:

- Click **Edit** next to any section, or
- Use the step navigation at the top to go back to a specific step.

> **Important:** Once you submit (Step 7), most fields cannot be edited unless the proposal is returned for revision.

Step 7 — Submit

[Screenshot: Proposal Wizard Step 7]

This is the final step before your proposal enters the review process.

Before submitting, confirm:

- All required fields are complete
- Budget is finalized
- All required documents are uploaded
- Co-investigators have been notified

To submit:

1. Read the submission declaration.
2. Check the confirmation checkbox.
3. Click **Submit Proposal**.

What happens next:

- Your proposal status changes from **Draft** to **Submitted**.
- A unique **Tracker Number** is generated (e.g., RTT-2026-00123).
- You receive a confirmation email and in-app notification.
- The proposal enters the **Validation Queue** for officer review.

Validation errors: If any required information is missing, you will see a list of errors. Correct the issues in the relevant steps and try again.

7.3 Managing Draft Proposals

Path: Proposals → My Proposals (filter by "Draft")

You can have multiple draft proposals in progress simultaneously.

Draft proposal actions:

- **Continue** — resume editing where you left off
- **Delete** — permanently delete the draft (you will be asked to confirm)
- **Preview** — view the proposal as it currently stands

> **Note:** Draft proposals are only visible to you. They do not appear in the validation queue or officer views.

7.4 Submitting a Proposal

See **Section 7.2 Step 7** for submission instructions. Key points:

- Submissions are only accepted during **active proposal calls**.
- Each call may limit the maximum number of proposals per PI.
- Once submitted, you cannot edit the proposal unless an officer returns it to you for revision.
- You will receive a **Tracker Number** upon successful submission.

7.5 Tracking Your Proposal

Path: Proposals → Track Proposal, or public URL: `/tracker`

You can track the status of any proposal using its Tracker Number without logging in.

To track a proposal:

1. Go to the Tracker page.
2. Enter the **Tracker Number** (e.g., RTT-2026-00123).
3. Click **Track**.

Information displayed:

- Current status
- Submission date
- Category and focus area
- Current stage in the workflow
- Workflow history (public summary)

[Screenshot: Proposal Tracker Page]

7.6 My Proposals

Path: Proposals → My Proposals

This page lists all proposals where you are the PI or a co-investigator.

Filtering options:

- Status (Draft, Submitted, Under Review, Funded, etc.)
- Academic year
- Category
- Keyword search

Actions available per proposal:

- **View** — full proposal details
- **Edit** — only available for drafts or proposals returned for revision
- **Withdraw** — cancel a submitted proposal (only before validation)
- **Track** — view workflow history
- **Download** — download uploaded documents

[Screenshot: My Proposals List]

7.7 All Proposals (Officers)

Path: Proposals → All Proposals

Available to officers and administrators. Shows all proposals in the system (filtered by your category or college scope if applicable).

Columns displayed:

- Tracker Number
- Title
- Category
- College
- PI Name
- Submission Date
- Current Status
- Actions

Filtering and search:

- Full-text search (title, abstract, keywords)
- Filter by status, category, college, academic year
- Sort by any column

Actions available per proposal (depending on role and status):

- View details
- Download documents
- View workflow history
- Take workflow action (validate, assign reviewer, schedule defence, etc.)

[Screenshot: All Proposals List - Officer View]

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8. Review and Evaluation

The RTT Platform uses a multi-stage evaluation process to ensure rigorous and fair assessment of all proposals.

8.1 Validation Queue

Path: Review & Evaluation → Validation Queue

Who can access: Research Officer, Community Officer, Technology Officer, Central Officer (within their category scope)

The validation queue shows all **Submitted** proposals that require an initial screening before entering peer review.

[Screenshot: Validation Queue]

Purpose of Validation: Validation is a pre-screening step to confirm the proposal meets basic eligibility requirements (correct category, complete documentation, meets call criteria) before it enters the full peer review process.

To validate a proposal:

1. Click **Review** on a proposal in the queue.
2. Read the proposal summary, PI information, and uploaded documents.
3. Choose one of three actions:
    - **Approve for Review** — proposal passes validation; status moves to "Validated" and enters the Blind Review queue.
    - **Return for Revision** — proposal has issues; it is returned to the PI with your comments.
    - **Reject** — proposal is ineligible; status moves to "Rejected" (you must provide a reason).
4. Enter your **comments or reason** (required for Return and Reject actions).
5. Click **Confirm**.

Outcome notifications:

- PI receives an email and in-app notification with the validation result and any comments.

8.2 Blind Review

Path: Review & Evaluation → Blind Review

Who can access: Officers (within their category scope)

After validation, proposals enter **Blind Review** — a peer review process where reviewer identities are kept anonymous.

[Screenshot: Blind Review Queue]

Assigning Reviewers

1. Click **Manage Reviews** on a proposal in the blind review queue.
2. The reviewer assignment panel opens showing available reviewers.
3. **Search and filter** reviewers by:
    - Name or email
    - Expertise area
    - Department or college
    - Current workload (to balance assignments)
4. Check for **conflict of interest**: the system automatically flags reviewers who are members of the proposal team.
5. Select the reviewers you want to assign.
6. Set a **Review Due Date**.
7. Click **Assign Reviewers**.

Reviewer notification: Each assigned reviewer receives an email and in-app notification with the proposal ID, deadline, and a link to the review form.

Managing Assignments

For each assignment, officers can:

- **Extend Due Date** — grant a reviewer more time
- **Reassign** — replace a reviewer who cannot complete the review
- **View Progress** — check if reviews have been submitted

Moving to Next Stage

Once all reviews are submitted (or the due date has passed), the officer can:

- **Pass to Open Defence** — if the proposal has sufficient positive reviews
- **Reject** — if reviews indicate the proposal does not merit further review

8.3 Open Defence

Path: Review & Evaluation → Open Defence

Who can access: Officers (within their category scope)

Proposals that pass blind review enter **Open Defence**, where the PI presents their proposal to a panel.

[Screenshot: Open Defence Queue]

Scheduling a Defence Session

1. Click **Schedule Defence** on a proposal in the Open Defence queue.
2. Fill in the session details:
   - **Date and Time**
   - **Venue** (physical location)
   - **Online Meeting Link** (for hybrid/virtual sessions)
   - **Panel Members** (select reviewers/officers to attend)
3. Click **Schedule**.

Notification: The PI and all panel members receive an email invitation with the session details.

Conducting and Recording a Defence

After the defence session takes place:

1. Return to the Open Defence queue and click **Process Result**.
2. Select the outcome:
   - **Accepted** — proposal is approved; status moves to "Accepted"
   - **Rejected** — proposal is declined (must provide reason)
3. Add session notes or recommendations.
4. Click **Submit Result**.

8.4 Central Evaluation

Path: Review & Evaluation → Central Evaluation

Who can access: Central Officer

After open defence, proposals that are accepted require a final approval from the Central Officer before being marked as **Accepted** and eligible for funding.

[Screenshot: Central Evaluation Queue]

To complete central evaluation:

1. Review the proposal, all review scores, and defence session notes.
2. Select **Approve** or **Reject**.

3. Add comments if needed.
4. Click **Submit Decision**.

8.5 Assigned Reviews (Reviewer View)

Path: Review & Evaluation → Assigned Reviews

Who can access: Any user assigned as a reviewer

This section shows all peer review assignments given to you.

[Screenshot: Assigned Reviews List]

To submit a review:

1. Click **Review** on an assigned proposal.
2. The proposal details are shown (PI name is hidden to preserve anonymity).
3. Answer each **evaluation question** across all categories.
    - Questions may be scored on a numerical scale or rated with descriptive levels.
    - Each question belongs to an evaluation category (Scientific Merit, Methodology, Budget, Impact, etc.).
4. Add any **general comments**.
5. Click **Submit Review**.

> **Important:** Once submitted, a review cannot be edited. Review your responses carefully before submitting.

Due dates: Your assignment list shows the due date for each review. Overdue reviews are highlighted in red.

8.6 Evaluation Criteria Management

Path: Review & Evaluation → Evaluation Criteria

Who can access: Officers and Super Admin

The evaluation criteria define the questions and scoring rubrics used in blind review.

Structure:

- **Evaluation Types** — a named set of criteria (e.g., "Standard Research Review")
- **Categories** — groupings of related questions within an evaluation type (e.g., "Scientific Merit", "Methodology")
- **Questions** — individual evaluation questions within each category

To create new evaluation criteria:

1. Create an **Evaluation Type** by clicking **New Evaluation Type**.
2. Under the type, add **Categories**.
3. Under each category, add **Questions** with their scoring method and maximum score.

8.7 Reviewer Workload

Path: Review & Evaluation → Reviewer Workload

Who can access: Officers, Central Officer

This dashboard shows the review workload across all assigned reviewers to help distribute assignments fairly.

[Screenshot: Reviewer Workload Dashboard]

Displays:

- Number of active assignments per reviewer
- Completed vs. pending reviews
- Average review completion time
- Overdue assignments highlighted

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9. Finance Module

> **Note:** The Finance module is a configurable feature. If you do not see these menu items, the feature may not be enabled for your institution.

9.1 Budget Allocations

Path: Budget → Budget Allocations

Who can access: Finance Officer, Super Admin

Budget allocations define the total funding available per college per fiscal year.

[Screenshot: Budget Allocations Page]

To create a budget allocation:

1. Click **New Allocation**.
2. Select the **College** and **Fiscal Year**.
3. Enter the **Total Allocated Amount**.

4. Click **Save**.

Allocation statuses:

- **Pending** — entered but not yet approved
- **Approved** — active allocation available for budget requests

Bulk approval: Select multiple pending allocations and click **Approve Selected**.

9.2 Budget Requests

Path: Budget → Budget Requests

Who can access: Finance Officer, College Officer, Staff (for own proposals)

Budget Requests are formal requests for project funds submitted by PIs after their proposals are funded.

[Screenshot: Budget Requests List]

Budget Request Workflow

```
Draft → Pending Signatures → Submitted → Under College Review → Approved / Rejected → D
```

Creating a Budget Request

1. Click **New Budget Request**.
2. Select the **Proposal** this request is for.
3. Select the **Form Template** (if multiple templates are configured).
4. Add **Budget Line Items**:
   - Category (Personnel, Equipment, etc.)
   - Description
   - Amount
   - Justification
5. Click **Save as Draft** or **Submit for Signatures**.

Signature Workflow

Budget requests require signatures from designated approvers before final submission.

1. Once all line items are added, click **Submit for Signatures**.
2. The system identifies required signatories from the form template.
3. Each signatory receives a notification to sign.

4. Signatories log in and click **Sign** on the budget request.
5. Once all signatures are collected, the request is automatically submitted.

College Review

After submission, the College Officer reviews the request:

- **Approve** — request proceeds to Finance Officer for disbursement
- **Reject** — request is returned with comments (must revise and resubmit)

9.3 Proposal Funding

Path: Budget → Proposal Funding

Who can access: Finance Officer

This queue shows all proposals that have been **Accepted** through the evaluation process and are waiting for a funding decision.

[Screenshot: Proposal Funding Queue]

To fund a proposal:

1. Click **Fund** on a proposal.
2. Review the proposal details and budget request.
3. Confirm the funding amount (or adjust if partial funding).
4. Click **Confirm Funding**.

What happens:

- Proposal status changes to **Funded**.
- An **Award Letter** is generated (available for download as PDF).
- The PI receives a funding notification.

To generate and download the Award Letter:

1. Go to **Awarded Proposals** (see Section 11).
2. Click **Download Award Letter** on the funded proposal.

9.4 Disbursements

Path: Budget → Disbursements

Who can access: Finance Officer

Disbursements track the actual transfer of funds to research teams after a budget request is approved.

[Screenshot: Disbursements Page]

To record a disbursement:

1. Click **New Disbursement** on an approved budget request.
2. Enter:
   - **Disbursement Date**
   - **Amount Disbursed**
   - **Payment Reference / Proof of Payment** (file upload)
3. Click **Record Disbursement**.

The budget request status changes to **Disbursed**, and the PI receives a notification.

9.5 Settlements

Path: Budget → Settlements

Who can access: Finance Officer, Staff (for own projects)

Settlements are the expense reports submitted by research teams after using disbursed funds.

[Screenshot: Settlements Page]

Submitting a Settlement (PI/Staff)

1. Go to **Budget** → **Settlements** and click **New Settlement** on a disbursed budget request.
2. Attach the **Expense Report** document.
3. Enter the **Total Amount Spent**.
4. Add notes or explanations.
5. Click **Submit Settlement**.

Verifying a Settlement (Finance Officer)

1. Review the submitted expense report.
2. **Verify** — confirm the expenses are valid and amounts match.
3. **Finalize** — mark the settlement as complete.
4. **Reject** — return with comments if discrepancies are found.

Budget request lifecycle completes when the settlement is finalized.

---

10. Monitoring Module

> **Note:** The Monitoring module is a configurable feature. Contact your administrator if it is not visible.

10.1 Midterm Evaluations

Path: Monitoring → Midterm Evaluations

Who can access: Officers, Finance Officer

Funded proposals undergo a **Midterm Evaluation** to assess progress before the project is completed.

[Screenshot: Midterm Evaluations List]

Scheduling a Midterm Evaluation (Officer)

1. Click **Schedule Evaluation** on an eligible funded proposal.
2. Enter:
   - **Evaluation Date, Time, and Venue**
   - **Evaluators** to attend
3. Click **Schedule**.

Bulk scheduling: Select multiple proposals and click **Schedule Selected** to set up evaluations simultaneously.

Submitting a Progress Report (PI)

Before the midterm evaluation, the PI submits a progress report:

1. Go to **My Proposals** → select the funded proposal.
2. Click **Submit Progress Report**.
3. Fill in:
   - **Progress Summary**
   - **Financial Utilization %** (how much of the budget has been used)
   - **Number of Publications** to date
   - **Challenges Encountered**
   - **Milestones Achieved**
   - Upload the **Progress Report** file
   - Upload the **Financial Report** file

4. Click **Submit**.

Recording Evaluation Results (Officer)

After the evaluation session:

1. Click **Record Result** on the scheduled evaluation.
2. Enter:
   - **Score** (numeric)
   - **Recommendations**
   - **Notes**
3. Click **Save Result**.

Depending on the outcome, the proposal may continue to completion or require additional action.

10.2 Completion Workshops

Path: Monitoring → Completion Workshops

Who can access: Officers

When a funded project is nearing completion, a **Completion Workshop** is scheduled to assess final outcomes.

[Screenshot: Completion Workshops List]

Scheduling a Completion Workshop (Officer)

1. Click **Schedule Workshop** on an eligible proposal.
2. Enter:
   - **Workshop Date, Time, Venue**
   - **Online Meeting Link** (if hybrid/virtual)
   - **Evaluators** to attend
3. Click **Schedule**.

Submitting Final Evidence (PI)

1. Upload the **Final Report** document.
2. Upload **Presentation Slides**.
3. Add **Photos** from the project.
4. Add **Video** links or uploads.
5. Submit a **Research Outputs** summary.

Recording Workshop Results (Officer)

After the workshop:

1. Record the **status outcome** (Completed / Needs Revision).
2. Add evaluation notes.
3. Click **Finalize Workshop**.

When finalized with a Completed outcome, the proposal status transitions to **Completed**.

10.3 Research Outputs

Path: Monitoring → Research Outputs

Who can access: Officers, Staff (for own proposals)

Research Outputs track the intellectual products generated by funded projects.

[Screenshot: Research Outputs Page]

Output types:

- Publication (journal article, conference paper, book chapter)
- Patent
- Presentation
- Technology product/prototype
- Community impact report

To add a research output:

1. Click **Add Output** on a funded or completed proposal.
2. Select the **Output Type**.
3. Enter the **Title** and **Description**.
4. Toggle **Ready for Repository** if the output should be published publicly.
5. Click **Save**.

10.4 Research Repository

Path: Monitoring → Repository (public) **Admin Path:** Monitoring → Manage Repository

The Research Repository is a public listing of completed research outputs.

[Screenshot: Research Repository - Public View]

Public users can:

- Browse all published research outputs

- Search by keyword, category, or year
- View output details

Administrators/Officers can:

- Mark eligible proposals as publishable
- Publish to the repository
- Unpublish if needed

To publish a proposal's outputs:

1. Go to **Manage Repository**.
2. Find the completed proposal.
3. Click **Publish to Repository**.
4. The proposal and its outputs appear on the public repository.

---

11. Awarded Proposals

Path: Proposals → Awarded Proposals

This page shows all proposals that have been funded.

[Screenshot: Awarded Proposals Page]

Information displayed:

- Tracker Number and Title
- PI Name and College
- Award Date
- Funded Amount
- Award Status (Funded, Disbursed, Completed)

Available actions:

- **View** — full proposal and award details
- **Download Award Letter** — PDF award notification
- **Track Budget** — link to the associated budget request
- **Export** — download the awarded proposals list as a CSV/Excel file

---

12. Complaints

Path: Review & Evaluation → Complaints

> **Note:** The Complaints module is a configurable feature.

The complaints module allows researchers and stakeholders to formally raise concerns about the review or funding process.

[Screenshot: Complaints Page]

Filing a Complaint (Staff / Researcher)

1. Go to **Review & Evaluation** → **Complaints**.
2. Click **New Complaint**.
3. Fill in:
   - **Proposal** related to the complaint
   - **Complaint Category**: Fairness / Bias / Process / Technical / Other
   - **Stage**: Which stage the issue occurred (validation, review, defence, funding, etc.)
   - **Complaint Level**
   - **Description**: Detailed account of the complaint
4. Click **Submit Complaint**.

> **Note:** You can only file one complaint per proposal per stage. Duplicate complaints will be rejected.

Complaint Statuses

Status	Meaning
Open	Complaint submitted, not yet assigned
Assigned	An officer has been assigned to investigate
Resolved	Complaint has been addressed
Escalated	Complaint has been referred to higher authority

Responding to a Complaint (Officer)

1. Go to the complaint from the Complaints list.

2. Click **Assign to Me** or assign to another officer.
3. Investigate the complaint.
4. Click **Respond**:
    - Enter your response text.
    - Select the resolution outcome.
5. Click **Mark as Resolved** or **Escalate** if needed.

Escalation

If a complaint cannot be resolved at the current level, it can be escalated to a higher authority. The complainant and the new assignee both receive notifications.

---

13. Similarity Flags

Path: Review & Evaluation → Similarity Flags

> **Note:** The Similarity module must be enabled by your administrator.

Who can access: Officers

The similarity detection module uses automated analysis to identify proposals that may share significant content with existing proposals.

[Screenshot: Similarity Flags Page]

What is displayed:

- Proposal title and tracker number
- Similarity score (percentage)
- Matched proposal(s)
- Flag status (Pending Review / Reviewed / Cleared)

To review a similarity flag:

1. Click **Review** on a flagged proposal.
2. View the similarity report showing matched sections.
3. Compare the flagged proposal with the matched proposal(s).
4. Choose:
    - **Clear Flag** — similarity is coincidental or acceptable (e.g., standard methodology descriptions)

- **Take Action** — proceed with further review, return proposal, or reject

5. Add notes explaining your decision.
6. Click **Save Decision**.

---

14. External Funds

Path: External Funds

> **Note:** The External Funds module is a configurable feature.

The External Funds module helps researchers identify and apply for funding from external donors and agencies.

14.1 Funding Opportunities

Path: External Funds → Funding Opportunities

[Screenshot: Funding Opportunities Page]

Browse available funding opportunities from external agencies. This page is also accessible to the public at `/funding-opportunities`.

Each opportunity shows:

- Donor/agency name
- Opportunity title and description
- Eligible categories
- Application deadline
- Funding amount range

14.2 External Fund Applications

Path: External Funds → External Fund Applications

Who can access: Staff, Officers

Manage applications for external funding opportunities.

[Screenshot: External Fund Applications List]

Application Statuses

```
Draft → Under Internal Review → Approved for Submission → Submitted →
Under Review → Awarded / Rejected / Withdrawn
```

Creating an External Fund Application

1. Click **New Application**.
2. Fill in:
   - **Application Title**
   - **Funding Opportunity** (select from registered opportunities)
   - **Category**: Research / Community / Technology / Innovation / Other
   - **Abstract and Goals**
   - **Principal Investigator**
   - **College and Department**
   - **Partner Institutions** (if applicable)
   - **Amount Requested** and **Currency**
   - **Project Start and End Dates**
   - **Keywords and Theme**
3. Add **Team Members**.
4. Add **Budget Details**.
5. Upload **Supporting Documents**.
6. Click **Save as Draft** or **Submit for Internal Review**.

Internal Review

A designated officer reviews the application internally before it is submitted to the external agency.

- **Approve for Submission** — the application is cleared for external submission
- **Reject** — the application is returned with comments

14.3 External Fund Awards

Path: External Funds → Awards

Tracks external funding that has been formally awarded.

Award features:

- Award amount and currency tracking
- **Milestones**: Key project deliverables with dates

- **Expenditures**: Track spending against the award
- **Document management**: Upload award agreement, progress reports

---

15. Conferences and Abstracts

15.1 Browsing Conferences

Path: Events → Conferences (public: `/conferences`)

Browse upcoming and past conferences organized by the institution.

[Screenshot: Conferences Public Page]

Each conference listing shows:

- Conference name and banner
- Date range and location (physical/virtual/hybrid)
- Brief description
- Registration link (if available)
- Featured speakers

To view a conference: Click on the conference name to see the full detail page including the schedule, speakers, sessions, and abstract submission instructions.

15.2 Submitting an Abstract

Path: Public → Conferences → [Conference Name] → Submit Abstract

Anyone (including non-logged-in users) can submit an abstract to an open conference.

[Screenshot: Abstract Submission Form]

To submit an abstract:

1. Navigate to the conference detail page.
2. Click **Submit Abstract**.
3. Fill in:
    - **Title** of your abstract
    - **Authors** and affiliations
    - **Abstract text** (typically 250–500 words)
    - **Keywords**
    - **Presentation preference** (oral / poster / either)

4. Click **Submit**.
5. You will receive a **Tracking Token** — save this to check the status of your abstract.

To track your abstract:

1. Go to `/my-abstracts` or click **My Abstracts** in the menu.
2. Enter your tracking token.
3. View the current status (Submitted, Under Review, Accepted, Rejected).

To withdraw your abstract:

1. Go to My Abstracts.
2. Click **Withdraw** on the abstract you wish to withdraw.
3. Confirm the withdrawal.

15.3 Managing Conferences (Admin)

Path: Events → Conferences (Admin)

Who can access: Admin, Super Admin

[Screenshot: Conference Management - Admin]

Creating a Conference

1. Click **New Conference**.
2. Fill in:
   - **Title** and **Slug** (URL-friendly name)
   - **Description**
   - **Banner Image** (upload)
   - **Start and End Dates** (with timezone)
   - **Location Type**: Physical / Virtual / Hybrid
   - **Physical Address** (for in-person or hybrid)
   - **Online Meeting Link** (for virtual or hybrid)
   - **Max Capacity**
   - **Registration Link** (external registration system URL if applicable)
   - **Tags**
   - **Featured** toggle (highlights the conference on the public page)
3. Add **Speakers**:
   - Speaker name, title, bio, and photo
   - Set sort order

4. Add **Sessions**:
    - Session title, date, time, presenter
5. Set **Status** (Draft / Published)
6. Click **Save**.

Managing Abstracts

See **Section 15.4** below.

15.4 Abstract Review (Admin)

Path: Events → Abstracts

Who can access: Admin, Officers assigned as abstract reviewers

[Screenshot: Abstract Reviews - Admin View]

To review an abstract:

1. Click **Review** on a submitted abstract.
2. Read the abstract content.
3. Assign a **Reviewer** (if not already assigned to yourself).
4. Submit your **Review Score** and **Comments**.
5. Change status to:
    - **Accepted** — abstract is approved for presentation
    - **Rejected** — abstract is not accepted
6. Click **Save Decision**.

The submitter is notified of the outcome via email.

---

16. Reports

> **Note:** The Reports module is a configurable feature.

Path: Reports

16.1 Generate Report

Path: Reports → Generate Report

Who can access: Officers, Admin, Super Admin

[Screenshot: Generate Report Page]

Available report types:

- Proposal Count by Category
- Proposal Count by College
- Proposals by Status
- College Performance Summary
- Budget Utilization Report
- Custom / Filtered Report

To generate a report:

1. Select the **Report Type**.
2. Set filter criteria:
    - **Date Range** (start date – end date)
    - **Category** (or "All Categories")
    - **College** (or "All Colleges")
    - **Status** (or "All Statuses")
    - **Academic Year**
3. Click **Generate**.
4. The report appears on screen.
5. Click **Export** to download as:
    - **CSV** (for spreadsheet use)
    - **Excel** (formatted spreadsheet)
    - **PDF** (for printing)

16.2 Proposal Statistics

Path: Reports → Proposal Statistics

[Screenshot: Proposal Statistics Page]

A visual summary of proposals across the system. Includes:

- Total proposals by status (bar chart)
- Proposals by category (pie chart)
- Proposals by college (table with counts and percentages)
- Submission trend over time (line chart)

16.3 College Performance

Path: Reports → College Performance

Who can access: Admin, Central Officer, Super Admin

[Screenshot: College Performance Report]

Shows the research performance of each college:

- Number of proposals submitted
- Acceptance rate
- Funded proposals
- Average review score
- Budget utilization rate

Export as CSV or PDF.

16.4 Budget Utilization

Path: Reports → Budget Utilization

Who can access: Finance Officer, Admin, Super Admin

[Screenshot: Budget Utilization Report]

Tracks budget allocation vs. actual spending:

- Allocated vs. disbursed amount per college
- Settlement completion rate
- Budget requests by status
- Overspend / underspend alerts

16.5 Analytics Dashboard

Path: Reports → Analytics Dashboard

Who can access: Admin, Super Admin

[Screenshot: Analytics Dashboard]

A comprehensive live dashboard combining all key metrics:

- Proposal pipeline visualization
- Review completion rates and timelines
- Reviewer performance metrics
- Budget utilization across all colleges

- Year-over-year comparisons
- KPI summary cards

---

17. Notifications

Path: User Menu → Notifications (bell icon)

[Screenshot: Notifications Panel]

The RTT Platform sends you notifications when important events occur.

Notification Types

Trigger	Recipients
Proposal submitted	Officer (validation queue)
Proposal validated (approved)	PI
Proposal returned for revision	PI
Proposal rejected	PI
Review assigned	Assigned reviewer
Review due date approaching	Reviewer
Defence scheduled	PI and panel members
Proposal funded	PI
Budget request signature needed	Signatory
Budget request approved/rejected	PI / Requester
Disbursement recorded	PI
Settlement verified	PI
Midterm evaluation scheduled	PI
Complaint assigned	Assigned officer
Complaint resolved	Complainant
Deadline reminder (7/3/1 day)	PIs with drafts
Abstract accepted/rejected	Abstract submitter
System alerts	Admins

Managing Notifications

To view notifications:

1. Click the **Bell icon** in the top navigation bar.
2. The notification panel slides open showing recent unread notifications.
3. Click any notification to go to the related page.
4. Click **Mark All Read** to clear the unread count.

Notification channels:

- **In-app** — always active; shows in the notification panel
- **Email** — can be configured per user (on/off)
- **Telegram** — requires linking your Telegram account; can be enabled in profile

To configure notification preferences:

1. Go to your **Profile** page.
2. In the **Notification Settings** section, toggle email and Telegram notifications on or off.
3. Click **Save Preferences**.

---

18. Public Pages

The following pages are accessible without logging in:

Page	URL	Description
Home	`/`	Landing page with system introduction
Explore Proposals	`/explore`	Browse publicly visible proposals
Proposal Calls	`/proposal-calls`	Active proposal calls
Funding Opportunities	`/funding-opportunities`	External funding opportunities
Repository	`/repository`	Published research outputs
Track Proposal	`/tracker`	Lookup by tracker number
Conferences	`/conferences`	Upcoming and past conferences
Conference Detail	`/conferences/{slug}`	Individual conference page
Submit Abstract	`/conferences/{slug}/submit-abstract`	Abstract submission form
My Abstracts	`/my-abstracts`	Track submitted abstracts by token
Download Resources	`/download`	Downloadable resources and templates

---

19. User Management (Admin)

Path: Administration → Users

Who can access: Admin, Super Admin, College Officer (own college only)

[Screenshot: User Management Page]

Viewing Users

The user list shows:

- Name and Email
- College and Department
- Role(s)
- Status (Active / Inactive / Guest)
- Last Login date

Filtering: Search by name/email, filter by role, college, or status.

Creating a New User

1. Click **New User**.
2. Fill in:
    - **Full Name** (required)
    - **Email Address** (required; must be unique)
    - **Employee ID** (optional)
    - **College** and **Department**
    - **Title / Position**
    - **Phone** and **Gender**
    - **Expertise** (relevant competencies for reviewer matching)
    - **Role(s)** — select one or more roles
    - **Status** — Active / Inactive / Guest
3. The system sends a **welcome email** with a temporary password or email verification link.
4. Click **Save**.

Editing a User

1. Click the user's name or the **Edit** icon.
2. Update any fields.

3. Click **Save Changes**.

Changing a User's Role

1. Open the user's profile.
2. In the **Roles** section, add or remove roles.
3. Click **Save**.

> **Note:** Role changes take effect immediately on next login or page refresh.

Deactivating a User

1. Open the user's profile.
2. Change **Status** to **Inactive**.
3. Click **Save**.

Inactive users cannot log in but their data is preserved.

Impersonating a User (Super Admin Only)

Super Admins can log in as another user to troubleshoot issues.

1. Find the user in the Users list.
2. Click the **Impersonate** icon (eye icon).
3. You are now logged in as that user.
4. To return to your admin account, click **Stop Impersonating** in the top bar.

> **Warning:** All actions taken while impersonating are performed as the impersonated user and are logged in the audit trail.

Bulk Actions

Select multiple users and choose from:

- **Assign Role** — apply a role to all selected users
- **Change Status** — activate or deactivate all selected users
- **Export** — download selected users as CSV

Importing Users (CSV)

1. Click **Import Users**.
2. Download the **CSV Template**.

3. Fill in the template with user data.
4. Upload the completed CSV file.
5. Review the import preview.
6. Click **Confirm Import**.

---

20. Administration

20.1 Colleges and Departments

Path: Administration → Colleges / Departments

Who can access: Admin, Super Admin

Colleges and departments define the organizational structure of your institution.

Managing Colleges

1. Go to **Administration** → **Colleges**.
2. Click **New College** to add a college.
3. Enter the **Name** and **Code** (abbreviated identifier).
4. Click **Save**.

Managing Departments

1. Go to **Administration** → **Departments**.
2. Click **New Department**.
3. Enter the **Name**, **Code**, and select the **Parent College**.
4. Click **Save**.

> Colleges and departments are used to categorize users and proposals and to filter data for college-scoped officers.

20.2 Thematic Areas

Path: Administration → Thematic Areas

Who can access: Super Admin

Thematic areas represent research priority areas used to classify proposals. Administrators can create, edit, or deactivate thematic areas.

20.3 Resources

Path: Administration → Resources

Who can access: Admin, Super Admin

Manage downloadable files available on the public **Download** page.

To add a resource:

1. Click **New Resource**.
2. Enter the **Title** and optional **Description**.
3. Upload the file.
4. Set as **Active** to make it publicly available.
5. Click **Save**.

20.4 Audit Logs

Path: Administration → Audit Logs

Who can access: Super Admin

The audit log provides an immutable record of all significant actions taken in the system.

[Screenshot: Audit Logs Page]

Each log entry shows:

- **Timestamp** — exact date and time
- **Actor** — the user who performed the action
- **Action Type** — what was done (created, updated, deleted, status changed, etc.)
- **Affected Record** — what was affected (proposal ID, user ID, etc.)
- **IP Address** — the IP from which the action was performed
- **Old Value** → **New Value** — before and after state (for changes)

Filtering:

- By date range
- By actor (user)
- By action type
- By record type

> **Note:** Audit logs are read-only and cannot be edited or deleted. This is enforced at the database level to ensure compliance.

20.5 System Monitor

Path: Administration → System Monitor

Who can access: Central Officer, Admin, Super Admin

Real-time monitoring of system health.

[Screenshot: System Monitor Dashboard]

Metrics displayed:

- **CPU Usage** — current server CPU utilization
- **Memory Usage** — RAM used vs. available
- **Disk Usage** — storage used vs. available
- **Request Statistics** — requests per minute, average response time
- **Failed Jobs** — jobs that failed to execute in the background queue

Performance Alerts:

- The system automatically detects anomalies (e.g., CPU spike > 90%, disk > 85%)
- Alerts appear in the monitor dashboard
- To resolve an alert, click **Acknowledge** and add a note

Failed Job Management:

- View the list of failed background jobs
- Click **Retry** to re-attempt a failed job
- Click **Delete** to remove a job from the failed queue

20.6 Feature Management

Path: Administration → Feature Management

Who can access: Super Admin only

Enable or disable major system modules without requiring code changes.

[Screenshot: Feature Management Page]

Toggleable features:

Feature	What it controls
Finance	Budget module (allocations, requests, disbursements, settlements)
Monitoring	Midterm evaluations, completion workshops, research outputs
Reports	Report generation and analytics dashboard
Complaints	Complaint filing and resolution workflow
Similarity	Plagiarism/similarity detection flags
External Funds	External funding opportunities and applications
Conferences	Conference and abstract management
Repository	Public research output repository
Self-Registration	Allow new users to register themselves

To toggle a feature:

1. Click the **toggle switch** next to the feature name.
2. Confirm the action in the dialog.
3. The change takes effect immediately — all users see the updated navigation instantly.

---

21. Settings

21.1 System Settings

Path: Settings → Settings

Who can access: Admin, Super Admin

Configure the core appearance and behavior of the RTT Platform.

[Screenshot: System Settings Page]

Setting	Description
System Name	The name displayed in the header and emails
System Tagline	A short description shown on the login page
Logo	Upload a logo image (PNG/SVG recommended)
Logo Width / Height	Pixel dimensions for the logo
Sidebar Color	Customize the navigation sidebar color
Announcement Banner	Toggle on/off; set the banner message
Footer Text	Text shown in the footer of every page
Feedback Popup	Enable/disable the feedback widget
Session Timeout	Inactivity timeout in minutes
Allow Self-Registration	Whether new users can register themselves
Allow Password Login	Whether email/password login is enabled
Auto-Backup	Enable scheduled database backups
Backup Time	Time of day to run scheduled backups
Maintenance Mode	Take the system offline for maintenance
Max Concurrent Sessions	Maximum active sessions per user

After making changes, click **Save Settings**.

21.2 Public Site Settings

Path: Settings → Public Site

Who can access: Admin, Super Admin

Configure the content displayed on public-facing pages (home page, about section, contact information, etc.).

21.3 Login Notices

Path: Settings → Login Notices

Who can access: Admin, Super Admin

Login Notices are messages displayed on the login page before users sign in. Use them for announcements, maintenance warnings, or important policy updates.

To create a login notice:

1. Click **New Notice**.
2. Enter the **Message** text.
3. Set the **Publish Date** (when the notice becomes visible).
4. Toggle **Active** to publish immediately.
5. Click **Save**.

Multiple active notices are shown in order on the login page. To remove a notice, toggle it to Inactive or delete it.

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22. Troubleshooting

Cannot Log In

Symptom	Solution
"Invalid credentials" error	Double-check email and password. Use "Forgot Password" if needed.
"Account is inactive"	Contact your administrator.
"Email not verified"	Check your inbox for a verification email. Click the link to verify.
SSO/Microsoft login fails	Contact IT support; may be an Azure AD configuration issue.
2FA code not received	Check your spam folder. Wait 2 minutes and click "Resend Code".
Too many attempts	Wait 5 minutes before retrying.

Cannot Submit a Proposal

Symptom	Solution
"No active proposal calls"	Check that the call deadline has not passed. Contact an officer.
Wizard validation errors	Read each error message carefully and fill in the missing/incorrect fields.
File upload fails	Check file size (must be within the limit) and file type (PDF, DOC, DOCX, etc.).
Cannot find co-investigator	The person must be a registered system user. Ask them to register first.
Proposal already submitted maximum	You have reached the per-PI limit for this call. Contact the officer.

Proposal Not Appearing in Queue

Symptom	Solution
Submitted proposal not in validation queue	Allow a few minutes for processing. Refresh the page.
"I can't see my proposal" (officer)	Check your category/college scope filters. Proposals outside your scope are not visible.
Proposal status hasn't changed after action	Refresh the page. Check the audit log for errors.

Notifications Not Received

Symptom	Solution
No email received	Check your spam/junk folder. Verify your email preferences in your profile.
Telegram notifications not working	Ensure your Telegram account is linked in your profile.
In-app notifications not showing	Click the bell icon and check the notification panel. Refresh the page.

File Download Issues

Symptom	Solution
Download link doesn't work	The download link may have expired. Refresh the page and try again.
"Access denied" when downloading	You may not have permission to access this file. Contact your officer.
PDF opens as blank	Try a different browser or PDF viewer.

Report Generation Issues

Symptom	Solution
Report shows no data	Adjust the date range and filters. Ensure data exists for the selected criteria.
Export file is empty	Same as above. Also check that you have at least one record matching the criteria.
"Reports feature is disabled"	Contact your Super Admin to enable the Reports module.

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23. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How do I know which proposal call to apply to? A: Go to **Proposals** → **Proposal Calls** and review the active calls. Each call specifies the eligible category, focus areas, deadline, and guidelines. Read the guidelines document before applying.

Q: Can I edit my proposal after submitting it? A: No. Once submitted, a proposal cannot be edited unless an officer returns it to you for revision. Check your notifications for revision requests.

Q: What is a Tracker Number and where do I find it? A: A Tracker Number (e.g., RTT-2026-00123) is a unique identifier assigned to your proposal upon submission. It appears in your confirmation email, in **My Proposals**, and on the **Track Proposal** page.

Q: How long does the review process take? A: The timeline varies by institution and call. Typical stages are:

- Validation: 1–2 weeks
- Blind Review: 3–6 weeks
- Open Defence: Scheduled after reviews
- Central Evaluation: 1–2 weeks

Check the proposal call guidelines for specific timelines.

Q: Can I submit a proposal for a colleague who is the actual PI? A: No. Proposals must be submitted by the Principal Investigator. If you need to assist with data entry, the PI must log in to complete the final submission.

Q: I was assigned as a reviewer but I have a conflict of interest. What should I do? A: Do not review the proposal. Contact the assigning officer immediately and explain the conflict. The system checks for co-authorship conflicts automatically but cannot detect all types of conflicts.

Q: How do I add a team member who is not registered in the system? A: You cannot add unregistered users to your proposal team. Ask the person to register for an account first. If self-registration is disabled, the administrator needs to create their account.

Q: Can I submit a proposal to multiple calls at the same time? A: This depends on the rules set by each proposal call (maximum proposals per PI). In general, you may submit to different calls for different categories. Check each call's guidelines.

Q: My session expired and I lost my progress. Is my draft saved? A: Yes. The wizard saves your work at each step when you click "Save & Next". If your session expired mid-step, you may lose unsaved data within that step, but all previously completed steps are saved.

Q: How do I link my Telegram account for notifications? A: Go to your **Profile** page, scroll to **Notification Settings**, and click **Link Telegram Account**. You will receive a code or be directed to the Telegram bot. Follow the instructions to complete the link.

Q: I cannot see the Finance / Monitoring / Reports menu. Why? A: These modules may be disabled by your administrator (Feature Management), or your role may not have permission to access them. Contact your system administrator.

Q: How do I export a list of proposals? A: Go to **All Proposals** or **My Proposals** and use the **Export** button to download the filtered list as a CSV file.

Q: Who do I contact for technical support? A: Contact your institution's RTT Platform administrator or IT support team. Use the **Feedback** link at the bottom of the page (if enabled) to submit a support request directly through the system.

End of User Manual

Document Information

- System: RTT — Research & Technology Transfer Platform
- Version: 1.0
- Date: June 2026
- For technical issues, contact your system administrator.